



Genome changing organism

Oxytricha trifallax is an organism that doesn't reproduce to increase their numbers but to change their genome <http://dgit.in/Oxytricha>



Virtual Travel has arrived

While virtual reality was being used in gaming, Framstore has built Teleporter that lets you experience vacations virtually <http://dgit.in/VRVacations>

ASUS X99-Deluxe

Piling on as many features as possible

Boards are becoming more and more feature laden as you go up the price bracket and with the X99 platform the extent to which manufacturers are willing to go to stand apart from the crowd can bring some surprising innovations to the scene. The Haswell-E processors have the voltage regulator circuits for different segments of the platform into one single regulator circuit.

ASUS noticed that there were a few pins holes on the new socket but there weren't missing pads on the processor. So with a little R&D they've incorporated a few extra pins onto the socket to even out the power delivery to the processor. This is to allow greater headroom for overclocking but this won't be around for long since Intel

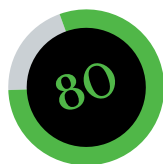


Price
₹31,300
(+Tax)

has already announced that they are ditching the FIVR (Fully Integrated Voltage Regulator) in the next architecture.

The board as a whole has plenty of PCIe slots but having four single-GPU graphics cards isn't an option here. But the board is priced lower than the Gigabyte GA-X99-SOC-Force which we looked at this month and comes with a lot of accessories bundled. Moreover, this board has a 1300 Mbps 802.11ac cum Bluetooth 4.0 adapter which makes it a much sweeter deal. However, we'd like to mention that you might want to get hold of the latest BIOS (we used O902) in order to get your memory modules to be recognised properly and the initial BIOS that the board ships with doesn't do a great job at reading XMP profiles of modules listed on the QVL. However, adopting a new platform this early always has its kinks and given enough time all manufacturers will have such minor issues resolved. So nothing to worry on that front.

Mithun Mobandas



Features80
Build80

Specifications

Chipset: Intel X99; **Memory support:** 4x3200(OC)MHz upto 64GB; **LAN:** 2x Intel Gigabit Ethernet; **Audio:** ALC1150 7.1; **SATA:** 12x SATA III; **Expansion:** 5x PCIe X16(x16+x8+x16+x8+x8); **Dimensions (LxWxD):** 305 mm x 264 mm; **Warranty:** 5 years

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HTC One E8

The One in new clothes

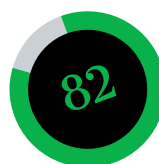
In terms of body and design, the E8 is quite a looker and we'll be honest, we felt the polycarbonate body is slightly better than metal as it seems to be less prone to scuffs, dents and scratches.

The One E8 runs on Android 4.4.2 Kit Kat with Sense 6 UI on top. This is exactly the same as the M8 and the smartphone also comes with the same lock-screen gestures which were exclusive to the M8.

Running on a Snapdragon 801, the One E8 is one of the most powerful smartphones available in the market. You get 2GB of RAM and 16GB of internal storage



Price
₹33,500



Feature81
Performance81
Value83
Design82

Specifications

Display: 5 inches Super LCD3, 1920x1080 resolution with Gorilla Glass 3 (441ppi); **Battery:** 2600mAh; **Storage:** 16GB; **Camera:** 13MP rear with flash, 5MP front; **SoC:** Qualcomm Snapdragon 801; **CPU:** Quad-core 2.5 GHz; **GPU:** Adreno 330; **RAM:** 2GB; **Operating system:** Android 4.4.2 with Sense 6; **Connectivity:** 3G, Dual-SIM, Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, USB with OTG

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and you can further expand it via a microSD card. The performance capabilities of the smartphone is at par with most of the high end smartphones and we didn't notice any snags or issues while using the device. The handset manages to run every high-end game with ease.

HTC ditched the duo-camera system which was present on the M8 with a 13MP sensor. Now you don't get the refocusing feature but everything else is available including filters, post editing tools, manual control, as well as Zoe. Picture quality is quite good although we think it could have been slightly better in certain areas. The shutter is super fast and the burst mode really impressed us.

We liked the E8 better than the M8, it offers similar specs in a design that is as elegant and as simple as the metal version. Plus it's cheaper!

Kunal Khullar